

MINISTRY OF SOCIAL JUSTICE AND EMPOWERMENT
INTERNAL ASSESSMENT NOTE -- RESTRICTED CIRCULATION

Subject: Procurement review, financial year 2025-26, second quarter.

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FINDINGS

One. Three of the fourteen tenders examined were awarded without a documented comparison against the published evaluation criteria. In each case the file contains a recommendation note but no scoring sheet. The absence of a scoring sheet does not by itself indicate irregularity, but it removes the ability to demonstrate that the award was made on the stated basis.

Two. The average interval between the closing date and the award decision was sixty one days, against a service standard of thirty. Two awards exceeded one hundred days. Delay of this order materially advantages incumbent suppliers, who continue to be paid under extension arrangements while a decision is pending.

Three. Two suppliers appear under slightly different registered names in the vendor master and were treated as distinct entities during evaluation. The review committee was not able to establish whether this affected the outcome of either tender, and recommends that the vendor master be deduplicated before the next cycle opens.

RECOMMENDATIONS

The committee recommends that scoring sheets be made a mandatory attachment at the point of award, that a standing exception report be produced for any award exceeding the service standard by more than fifty per cent, and that the vendor master be reconciled against the register of companies annually.

A response to these recommendations is requested from each regional office within thirty working days of the date of this note. Recipients are reminded that this document is individually accountable to the person named on the distribution list and that its onward transmission, in whole or in part, is a breach of the terms under which it was released.